

Posture, Transfer, Low Point & Driver

Three sessions a week, forty minutes each, plus ten minutes at home.
If the week collapses, keep Block A and drop everything else.

01 Read this before you hit anything

WHERE YOU ARE NOW — READ THIS BEFORE THE DIAGNOSIS BELOW

Over the top is resolved and the low point has moved forward. Those were the two hardest items on this card. What remains is confirmation on grass and a wrist flinch — a materially smaller job than the one this plan started with. The chain below is kept as reference for *why* the faults clustered, not as a current description of your swing.

Toe strikes, missing divots, chipping fat and the pull-hook are one fault wearing four costumes. Your lead leg pushes up too early, your whole body rises, and everything downstream is a consequence.

THE CHAIN

Lead leg extends early → body rises → swing radius shortens → clubhead arrives closer to you and higher on the face → **toe strike, thin, low point behind the ball** → hands flip to rescue it → face closes to path → **pull-hook**

Your own numbers sit on this chain exactly. Trackman confirmed toe-down delivery. Your best 5-iron was a centre strike at −3.2 face-to-path; the worst was a high-face thin at +11.9. The face only misbehaves once the strike already has. **Work at the front of the chain and the rest resolves without being addressed directly.**

THE NUANCE THAT MATTERS MOST

Lead leg extension is *not* the fault. Good players push hard off the lead leg — it is where speed comes from. The difference is direction: their pelvis moves **back and away from the ball line** while the chest stays down over the ball. Yours is thrusting **toward** the ball. At 87 mph you cannot spare the leg drive. Redirect it, never kill it.

Confirm it in sixty seconds

Set up with your glutes touching a wall or the back of a chair. Make slow swings. If your backside loses contact on the way down, that is early extension. Film it down-the-line if you want it on record.

Free check while you are there

With a 7-iron at address, arms hanging, you want roughly **one hand-width between the butt of the grip and your lead thigh**. Standing too far from the ball produces toe strikes on its own, with no swing fault required.

HOLD OFF ON THIS

Do not bend the P790 lie angles yet. Toe-down delivery caused by early extension will change once the posture does, and you would be fitting the clubs to a fault you are in the middle of removing. Revisit at week eight.

03 The rule that protects your driver

Irons want low point **ahead** of the ball. Driver wants it **behind** — you are hitting up on a teed ball. Carrying the iron feel to the tee delofts a driver already spinning at 2120 rpm, roughly 700 short of what 87 mph needs.

Never practise iron low point and driver in the same twenty-minute block. Separate them with a break and a rehearsal swing that resets the feel.

A closed face is a delofted face. Part of the missing driver spin is face-to-path, not the head. As the face neutralises, spin should climb toward the 2600–3000 window on its own.

04 Kit

Athlete's foot spray or line powder (divot start line *and* face strike location) · a chair or wall · chalk line or two alignment sticks · one towel · one headcover · phone on a stand for down-the-line video.

A rehearsal that bottoms out correctly is the best news on this card. **You are not missing a movement — you own it.** The ball takes it away from you. That changes the job entirely: not "learn a new pattern" but "stop the ball from triggering the old one," and the two need completely different practice.

What the ball does is turn a swing *through* a space into a hit *at* an object. Your brain re-aims the whole motion at the ball as an endpoint rather than a waypoint, grip pressure spikes, the body slows to steer, and the hands take over to save it. That produces the early bottom and the flip precisely as you see them.

First, verify it honestly — the rehearsal divot test

Five practice swings on turf, **at real speed**, somewhere the marks show. Look at where they start relative to where a ball would sit.

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS
Marks start clearly ahead of the ball position	The pattern is genuinely there. Your problem is purely transfer — work the protocol below and expect fast progress.
Marks start behind, or the club barely brushes	The rehearsal is just slower and less committed. "It feels fine" is an illusion, and Blocks A–C still need the full mechanical work.

Most people land between the two. Be honest here — it decides where your eight weeks go.

THE TRANSFER PROTOCOL — GOVERNS EVERY BLOCK ON THIS CARD

1.

Rehearsal and shot are one unit. Rehearse, step in, hit within five seconds. No re-setting, no re-gripping, no waiting.

2.

Same speed both times. If the rehearsal is slower, it is not a rehearsal.

3.

Look at a spot 10 cm ahead of the ball, or at its front edge. Never the back of it. Where you look is where the club wants to bottom out.

4.

Grip pressure four out of ten — and check it is still four at the top.

5.

Cut your time over the ball. Long deliberation is rising tension, and tension is how the ball wins.

6.

Score the swing, not the shot. Rate every ball 1–5 on how close it felt to the rehearsal, and ignore where it went. Hardest rule here, and the one that matters most.

A Posture retention & ball transfer

This is now the first block of every session and the only one that is never cut. Face spray goes on every fifth shot — **strike location is the scoreboard here, not ball flight**.

Drill	Reps	What it fixes
Chair drill Glutes against a chair back. The lead glute should <i>press into it</i> through impact, not leave it. Twenty slow rehearsals, then ten with a ball.	20 + 10	The root move. Teaches the pelvis to go back and away instead of toward the ball.
Heel-bias exaggeration Deliberately try to strike the heel side of the face. Spray the face every five shots.	20	You will land in the middle. For strike location, exaggeration beats caution every time.
Lead heel planted Half shots keeping the lead heel down throughout. Feel the hip clearing <i>rotationally</i> rather than jumping. Add speed back gradually.	15	Separates rotation from vertical thrust. This is the feel you are trying to keep.
Setup distance audit One hand-width, grip butt to lead thigh, arms hanging. Check before every drill.	every session	Removes the free toe strikes that have nothing to do with your swing.
Down-the-line video One clip per session, same angle, same spot. Draw a line down your backside at address.	1	Early extension is almost impossible to feel accurately. You need to see it.
Continuous swing Pendulum back and forth without ever stopping. On the third pass, a ball happens to be in the way.	10	Removes the setup-and-freeze ritual, which is where the tension builds.
Tee-only ladder Ten swings at a bare tee in the ground, then ten at a teed ball, then ten off turf.	30	Reintroduces the ball in stages instead of all at once.
Eyes closed Half shots, eyes shut once you are set. Yes, really.	10	Kills visual fixation and outcome steering outright. Strike usually improves immediately.
Swish past the ball Club turned upside down. The loudest swish must happen <i>past</i> where the ball would be.	15	Attacks the deceleration directly. You cannot steer and accelerate at the same time.

Graduation: when face spray shows the strike pattern centred and no longer drifting toward the toe across twenty shots, Block A drops to a ten-minute warm-up rather than a full block.

Block B

B Chipping low point

Setup baseline, every session: narrow stance, feet slightly open, ball just back of centre, handle 2–4 cm ahead, seventy percent of pressure in the lead foot — and it *stays* there through the strike.

Drill	Reps	What it fixes
Line drill Chalk line on turf, ball sitting on it. The brush mark must start on or ahead of the line. Score every ball.	20	Direct low-point feedback. Your scoring drill for this block.
Lead-arm only Trail hand off entirely, 10 m chips.	15	Makes flipping physically impossible.
Towel behind Towel laid 10 cm behind the ball. Never touch it.	15	Kills the hang-back-and-scoop pattern.
Lead-foot only Trail toe on the ground for balance, nothing more.	15	Forces pressure forward early.
Freeze finish Normal chips. Hold the impact position three seconds and look at the shaft.	10	Builds the picture of what a forward low point actually feels like.

Graduation: at 16 of 20 on the line drill, add the **landing ladder** — three towels at 3, 6 and 9 m, five balls each, random order. Strike first, distance second.

C Low point confirmation

Steepest and safety are not the same thing. Margin for error comes from the low point sitting ahead of the ball, which you have already moved. A steeper delivery makes the bottom of the swing more V-shaped, so any error in low point position gets punished harder. A shallower, U-shaped bottom tolerates variation better. Shallow players typically have *better* distance control and *worse* performance from rough and bad lies. That is the real trade, and it is not a bad one to be on the wrong side of.

THE GOAL, RESTATED

Not a divot. **A mark after the ball, however shallow.** A bruise or a scuff of grass counts, and it means the low point is where you want it. If the club leaves nothing at all, the low point is still at or behind the ball. If it scuffs — you are done. Take the win and move on to the next shot.

MATS HAVE BEEN LYING TO YOU

On a mat, contact 2 cm behind the ball still produces a decent flight because the club skids into it. A mat cannot teach you low point and will actively mislead you here. **Every drill in this block happens on grass.**

The desensitisation ladder

The wrist flinch is the real obstacle, and it deserves respect rather than willpower. A flinch is not weakness and you will not override it by committing harder. **Move up a rung only when the current one is boring** — expect two or three sessions per rung. Going too fast rebuilds the fear you are trying to remove.

RUNG	DO THIS	WHY
1	Softest, dampest turf you can find. Short iron, half swings, <i>no ball</i> — just brush the grass. Twenty reps.	Turf contact with zero consequence attached.
2	Deliberate fat shots at 50% speed. Aim 3 cm behind the ball on purpose. Ten of them.	The key rung. Proves to your nervous system that turf contact does not hurt. Do not skip it.
3	Repeat rung 2 at 70%, then at 85%, across separate sessions.	Creeps the speed back without re-triggering the flinch.
4	Ball on a low tee on grass. Normal 9-iron shots, aiming to mark the turf past the tee.	Removes the fat-shot risk entirely while you practise marking turf.
5	Ball on turf. 9-iron, then 8, then 7. Check for a mark after every shot.	Normal golf, with the fear disarmed.

Two things throughout: grip pressure at four out of ten — a tight grip transmits shock straight into the wrists while a soft one absorbs it. And if wrist pain actually recurs, get it looked at rather than training through it. Pain rebuilds the flinch faster than any drill removes it.

Drills, once the ladder is done

DRILL	REPS	WHAT IT FIXES
Mark check Off grass. Log mark / no mark for every shot. 9-iron first, then 8, then 7.	10 each	Your scoring drill for this block. Binary, honest, and nothing to do with depth.
Line drill on grass Chalk line, ball sitting on it. The mark must start on or ahead of the line.	15	Confirms low point position without any reference to divot depth.
Punch shots Waist-high back, chest-high through, low flight.	10	Produces forward shaft lean, and reliably leaves a mark.
Step drill Feet together, step onto the lead foot as the club changes direction. 8-iron.	15	Pressure shift as a transition move rather than an afterthought.
Feet together Fuller swings with the feet touching.	10	Centres the strike and exposes balance loss.

BEFORE BLAMING YOUR SWING FOR SPIN

Check your 5-iron's actual loft. Strong-lofted distance irons often put a 5-iron at 23–24° — a traditional 4-iron — and hollow-body heads are low-spin by design. No swing change fixes that. The cheaper spin levers: clean grooves, a dry face and ball (a real factor in Finnish conditions), and centred strikes, since a centred hit spins meaningfully more than a toe strike. At roughly 75 mph club speed a long iron is never stopping quickly. Plan to run those in, and put your stopping-power expectations on the short irons and wedges.

D Driver basics

Setup checklist — two minutes daily at home

- Ball off the lead heel
- Tee height: half the ball above the crown
- Stance a shoulder-width plus a little — wider than your irons
- Trail shoulder noticeably lower, spine tilted away from target roughly 5–10°
- Pressure 55% in the trail foot; hands level with or slightly behind the ball
- **No forward press**

DRILL	REPS	WHAT IT FIXES
Tee-ahead Second tee pushed in 20 cm ahead of the ball, only 1 cm showing. Don't clip it.	15	Angle of attack, upward.
High-tee strike Tee a full ball above the crown; strike the upper half of the face.	15	Attack angle and launch together.
Hold-off 9-to-3 Half swings. Glove logo pointing at the target past impact; the toe does not roll over the heel.	15	The closed face. Your biggest driver leak.
Start-line gate Two sticks forming a gate 4 m ahead, set so the ball must start at or right of the target.	10	Stops the pull-hook at its source.
Grip audit Lead hand showing two knuckles, trail palm facing the target.	every session	A strong grip shuts the face automatically, whatever your swing does.

Full swings only after the 9-to-3 work. Ten good ones beat forty.

05

The week

SLOT	CONTENTS
Daily at home — 10 min	15 chair-drill rehearsals · driver setup rehearsal · 20 lead-arm-only chip swings · 10 step-drill rehearsals, no ball.
Session 1 — Short game, 45 min	Block A chair drill, 10 min → Block B in full → landing ladder.
Session 2 — Irons, 50 min (grass only)	Block A warm-up, 10 min → Block C: current ladder rung, then mark check → 10 balls to random targets.
Session 3 — Mixed, 55 min	Block A, 15 min → 10 min chipping → 10 min 9-to-3 irons → break → 20 min Block D.

Phasing — stages, not weeks

You are past the original weeks 1–2. Progress by stage now, and let each one take as long as it takes.

STAGE	CONTENTS
1 — Disarm 2–3 sessions per rung	Ladder rungs 1–3 on grass. Block A as a warm-up only. No scoring, no divot expectations, nothing carried to the course. The single objective is that turf contact stops feeling dangerous.
2 — Confirm	Ladder rungs 4–5, then the mark check drill. Log mark / no mark honestly. Driver enters in Session 3.
3 — Randomise	Never two of the same club in a row, one ball per target, played for a score. Driver gets full attention.

ON THE COURSE, FOR NOW

Take the divot question off the table entirely. Play the strike you have — your iron results are already good on average, and a shallow delivery is a legitimate way to play golf, not a fault to be fixed mid-round. The ladder belongs on the range. Trying to manufacture a divot on the course is exactly how you produce the duffs that started the flinch.

06

Scorecard — log weekly

METRIC	BASELINE	INTERIM	TARGET	ACTUAL — LOG BY DATE
Face strike, heel-toe spread (7-iron)	toe	centred	≤10 mm	
Face strike, height spread	22 mm	15 mm	≤10 mm	
Chair contact retained (out of 10 swings)	—	7	9	
Swing-match rating, average of 20 (1–5)	—	3.5	4.0+	
Shots paired to a rehearsal within 5 sec (of 20)	—	20	20	
Chip line drill, divot at/ahead of line (of 20)	—	15	18	
Turf mark after the ball, 9-iron off grass (of 10)	—	7	9	
Same, 7-iron off grass (of 10)	—	5	8	
Desensitisation ladder rung reached (1–5)	—	3	5	
Driver angle of attack	—	0°	+1 to +3°	
Driver spin	2120	2400	2600–3000	
Driver face-to-path	closed	within −3	−1 to +2	

Carry distance is deliberately absent. It follows the strike, and tracking it now only tempts you into swinging harder at a fault you are still removing. Note also that centring a toe strike will add distance on its own, without a single mph of extra speed.

TRAP	WHY IT COSTS YOU
Scoring the shot instead of the swing	The single biggest trap for you. Judging by ball flight is exactly the outcome-focus that makes the ball hijack the swing in the first place. Rate the feel, walk away, look at the face spray later.
A 70% practice swing	A slower rehearsal bottoms out correctly for reasons that have nothing to do with your real swing. It flatters you and transfers nothing. Rehearse at full speed or do not count it.
Standing over the ball deliberating	Every extra second raises grip pressure and re-aims your intent at the ball. Short routine, commit, go.
Trying to stop the lead leg from extending	The most common overcorrection, and it kills speed you cannot spare at 87 mph. The leg should still push hard — the pelvis just travels back and away rather than toward the ball.
Standing closer to the ball to cure toe strikes	Treats the symptom and usually makes early extension worse, because you now have even less room for the arms. Set the one hand-width distance and leave it alone.
Bending the lie angles now	You would be fitting the irons to a delivery you are actively changing. Retest at week eight, then decide.
Chasing divot depth	Depth is a by-product of your natural angle of attack, not a skill. A shallow player who marks the turf after the ball has a correct strike. Judging yourself on how much earth flies is a fast route back to the chopping motion you just removed.
Practising low point on mats	The club skids, so contact well behind the ball still flies acceptably. Mats will tell you the problem is solved when it is not. Grass only for Block C.
Blaming your swing for iron spin	Check the loft on the club first. A 23° hollow-body "5-iron" at 75 mph will not stop quickly no matter what your delivery looks like.
Pushing through wrist pain	Discomfort during the ladder is expected; pain is not. One painful session will rebuild the flinch faster than a month of drills removes it.
Trying to "hit down" by chopping	Steepening the shaft with the hands moves low point <i>backwards</i> and produces exactly the fat-and-thin pattern you already have. The move is pressure and rotation, never arms.
Holding shaft lean rigidly	Freezing the wrists to prevent the flip kills clubhead speed and face control at once. Let the corrected low point remove the flip for you.
Driver first, or driver when tired	Last block for a reason. Early extension and the closed face both worsen under fatigue, when the hands take over from the body.
All block practice, never random	Weeks 1–4 genuinely need repetition. But if you never randomise, none of it survives contact with the first tee.
Letting soft Muurame turf flatter you	Wet ground lets a slightly fat strike still go somewhere respectable. Judge the divot start and the face spray, not the result.

IF YOU ONLY REMEMBER ONE LINE

The toe strike, the missing divot and the pull-hook are all the same fault. Keep the backside back and you are working on all three at once.